SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #51 · POLITICS AND GOVERNMENT

"The people who disagree with me are evil."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Constant exposure to outrage, friends who share one view, and media that profits from anger teach us to see the other side as enemies. Friendships and families fracture. We feel righteous but also anxious and angry.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, "Love your enemies and pray for those who persecute you." Paul writes, "Our struggle is not against flesh and blood," and "Do not repay anyone evil for evil... If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone." "A gentle answer turns away wrath." James says, "Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak, and slow to anger." Proverbs warns, "He who answers a matter before he hears it—this is folly and disgrace to him." We can hold convictions firmly and still treat those who differ as people made in God's image.

> *"But I tell you, love your enemies and pray for those who persecute you"* (Matthew 5:44).

Also see

> "For our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the powers of this world's darkness, and against the spiritual forces of evil in the heavenly realms" (Ephesians 6:12).

> "Do not repay anyone evil for evil. Carefully consider what is right in the eyes of everybody. If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone. Do not avenge yourselves, beloved, but leave room for God's wrath. For it is written: 'Vengeance is Mine; I will repay, says the Lord.' On the contrary, 'If your enemy is hungry, feed him; if he is thirsty, give him a drink. For in so doing, you will heap burning coals on his head.' Do not be overcome by evil, but overcome evil with good" (Romans 12:17–21).

> "A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger" (Proverbs 15:1).

> "My beloved brothers, understand this: Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak, and slow to anger, for man's anger does not bring about the righteousness that God desires" (James 1:19–20).

Common self-statements

- They are the problem.
- They want to destroy the country.
- Anyone who thinks that is a bad person.
- There is no good in them.
- I cannot be friends with them.
- I have to fight them.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing people as completely good or evil.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know their motives.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling angry and concluding that they are wicked.
- Fortune telling: Predicting the worst from them.

Challenging questions

- What do I actually know about the people who disagree with me?
- Do I know anyone personally with a different view, and are they evil?
- What does Jesus say about enemies?
- How is my anger affecting me?
- What are my own blind spots?
- How can I listen before I answer?

Truth summary

> People who disagree with me are made in God's image, not enemies to destroy. I can hold convictions firmly, listen well, and speak with gentleness. My struggle is not against flesh and blood.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anger
- Judgmental
- Prejudice
- Peace
- Forgiveness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Death and Dying
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Truth Be Told — Matthew West featuring Carly Pearce
Honesty about struggles makes room for grace and support instead of pretending to be fine.

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "The people who disagree with me are evil"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"The people who disagree with me are evil." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I really know?
- ☐ Do I know someone personally?
- ☐ What does Jesus say?
- ☐ How is anger affecting me?
- ☐ What are my blind spots?
- ☐ How can I listen?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am called to love my enemies.
- ☐ My struggle is not against flesh and blood.
- ☐ A gentle answer turns away wrath.
- ☐ I can be quick to listen.
- ☐ Peace is possible where I can.
- ☐ Others are made in God's image.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Matthew 5:44
  "But I tell you, love your enemies and pray for those who persecute you."
- ☐ Proverbs 15:1
  "A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger."
- ☐ James 1:19–20
  "My beloved brothers, understand this: Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak, and slow to anger, for man's anger does not bring about the righteousness that God desires."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Listen first: Each week, note one conversation where you listened before answering.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Matthew 5:44 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will love my enemies and pray for them.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Judgmental" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Check your diet. Notice how much outrage media you consume.
- ☐ Listen once. Ask someone with a different view to explain why.
- ☐ Pray for them. Pray for the person or group you resent.
- ☐ Memorize Proverbs 15:1. Use it when you feel heated.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "The people who disagree with me are evil": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Listen first
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~The people who disagree with me are evil.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have judged those who disagree with me. Soften my heart, teach me to listen, and help me love my enemies as You command. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #52 · POLITICS AND GOVERNMENT

"Things will never get better in this country."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Every generation has seen decline, and today's news cycle makes the problems seem endless. After disappointment with leaders and policies, hopelessness sets in, and we withdraw or grow bitter.

What Scripture teaches

Jeremiah told exiles, "Seek the prosperity of the city to which I have sent you as exiles. Pray to the LORD on its behalf." Solomon cautioned that it is unwise to ask why the old days were better than these (Ecclesiastes 7:10). Paul urged "petitions, prayers, intercessions, and thanksgiving be offered for everyone—for kings and all those in authority." "Our citizenship is in heaven." Nations rise and fall, but God's purposes stand. Hope does not depend on any government, and neither does our calling to do good.

> *"Seek the prosperity of the city to which I have sent you as exiles. Pray to the LORD on its behalf, for if it prospers, you too will prosper"* (Jeremiah 29:7).

Also see

> "Do not say, 'Why were the old days better than these?' For it is unwise of you to ask about this" (Ecclesiastes 7:10).

> "First of all, then, I urge that petitions, prayers, intercessions, and thanksgiving be offered for everyone— for kings and all those in authority—so that we may lead tranquil and quiet lives in all godliness and dignity" (1 Timothy 2:1–2).

> "But our citizenship is in heaven, and we eagerly await a Savior from there, the Lord Jesus Christ" (Philippians 3:20).

> "A man's heart plans his course, but the LORD determines his steps" (Proverbs 16:9).

Common self-statements

- It is all going downhill.
- Nothing we do matters.
- The best days are behind us.
- No leader can fix this.
- It is hopeless.
- I want to give up on it.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing the country is either great or doomed.
- Mind reading: Assuming everyone has given up.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling discouraged and concluding that nothing will change.
- Fortune telling: Predicting only decline.

Challenging questions

- What good is happening that the news does not cover?
- What has improved in history that people once thought impossible?

- What does Scripture say to people in hard places?
- What can I do locally that makes a difference?
- Where is my deepest hope placed?
- How is hopelessness affecting me?

Truth summary

> My hope rests in God, not in any government. I can pray for my nation, seek its good where I live, and do what I can. Citizenship in heaven frees me to serve here without despair.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Trust
- Worldly
- Will of God
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Things will never get better in this country"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Things will never get better in this country." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What good am I missing?
- ☐ What has improved?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ What can I do locally?
- ☐ Where is my hope?
- ☐ How is despair affecting me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God's purposes stand.
- ☐ I can seek the good of my city.
- ☐ I can pray for those in authority.
- ☐ My citizenship is in heaven.
- ☐ Good is still happening.
- ☐ I can do something locally.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Jeremiah 29:7
  "Seek the prosperity of the city to which I have sent you as exiles. Pray to the LORD on its behalf, for if it prospers, you too will prosper."
- ☐ 1 Timothy 2:1–2
  "First of all, then, I urge that petitions, prayers, intercessions, and thanksgiving be offered for everyone— for kings and all those in authority—so that we may lead tranquil and quiet lives in all godliness and dignity."
- ☐ Philippians 3:20
  "But our citizenship is in heaven, and we eagerly await a Savior from there, the Lord Jesus Christ."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Hope in action: Each week, note one good thing you did or noticed locally.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Jeremiah 29:7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will seek the good of my city and pray for it.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Limit the news. Choose a set time and stop.
- ☐ Do one local good. Serve a neighbor or a cause.
- ☐ Pray for leaders. Name them in prayer.
- ☐ Read Jeremiah 29. Notice the instruction to exiles.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Things will never get better in this country": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Hope in action
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Things will never get better in this country.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am discouraged about our country. Anchor my hope in You, teach me to seek the good of my city, and use me where I am. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #53 · POLITICS AND GOVERNMENT

“My vote, my voice, and my life don't matter.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Feeling unheard by officials, lost in large systems, or outvoted again and again can make participation seem pointless. Some also grew up in settings where speaking up was punished. We shrink and stay quiet.

What Scripture teaches

God told Jeremiah, “Seek the prosperity of the city... for if it prospers, you too will prosper.” Jesus said, “Even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows.” Mordecai asked Esther whether she had come to the kingdom for such a time as this. Proverbs says, “He who answers a matter before he hears it...” and urges honest speech: “speak truthfully to his neighbor.” In God’s eyes, every person matters. How and whether we engage civic life is for each of us to decide prayerfully, but we are not nobodies.

> *“And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows”* (Luke 12:7).

Also see

> “Seek the prosperity of the city to which I have sent you as exiles. Pray to the LORD on its behalf, for if it prospers, you too will prosper” (Jeremiah 29:7).

> “Therefore each of you must put off falsehood and speak truthfully to his neighbor, for we are all members of one another” (Ephesians 4:25).

> “For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:13–14).

> “For by the grace given me I say to every one of you: Do not think of yourself more highly than you ought, but think of yourself with sober judgment, according to the measure of faith God has given you” (Romans 12:3).

Common self-statements

- One voice changes nothing.
- No one listens to people like me.
- Why bother?
- The system ignores me.
- I am invisible.
- My life is small.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing my voice has total or no effect.
- Mind reading: Assuming officials do not care.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling powerless and concluding that I am.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that nothing I do matters.

Challenging questions

- Where have I felt unheard, and who was involved?

- What small things have I influenced?
- What does God say about my value?
- Where do I have the most influence: home, church, work, neighborhood?
- What does faithful citizenship look like for me?
- What is one step I can take?

Truth summary

> I matter to God, and my life has influence in places I may overlook. I can pray, vote, speak, and serve as I am able, without carrying the weight of the whole nation.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Worldly
- Will of God
- God, All Knowing
- Hopeless

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My vote, my voice, and my life don't matter"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My vote, my voice, and my life don't matter." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where have I felt unheard?
- ☐ What have I influenced?
- ☐ What does God say?
- ☐ Where is my influence?
- ☐ What is faithful citizenship?
- ☐ What is my step?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God knows me and values me.
- ☐ I am worth more than many sparrows.
- ☐ My life has influence.
- ☐ I can seek the good of my city.
- ☐ I can speak truthfully.
- ☐ I do not carry the nation.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Luke 12:7**
  "And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows."
- ☐ **Jeremiah 29:7**
  "Seek the prosperity of the city to which I have sent you as exiles. Pray to the LORD on its behalf, for if it prospers, you too will prosper."
- ☐ **Ephesians 4:25**
  "Therefore each of you must put off falsehood and speak truthfully to his neighbor, for we are all members of one another."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Where I make a difference: Each week, note one small way you contributed.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Luke 12:7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am worth more than many sparrows, so my life matters.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ List your circles. Write where you have influence.
- ☐ Do one thing. Vote, volunteer, or write a note.
- ☐ Speak truthfully. Say one honest word kindly.
- ☐ Pray for your city. Pray by name for places and people.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My vote, my voice, and my life don't matter": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Where I make a difference
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My vote, my voice, and my life don't matter.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I feel small and unheard. Thank You for counting me valuable. Show me where I can serve, speak, and pray, and give me peace about the rest. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #54 · POLITICS AND GOVERNMENT

“If the right people were in power, I would finally be safe.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Elections are framed as life-or-death, and each side warns of catastrophe if the other wins. Fear and hope get attached to leaders, and our sense of safety rises and falls with the polls.

What Scripture teaches

“Put not your trust in princes, in mortal man, who cannot save.” “Some trust in chariots and others in horses, but we trust in the name of the LORD our God.” “It is better to take refuge in the LORD than to trust in man.” “The king’s heart is a waterway in the hand of the LORD; He directs it where He pleases.” Paul writes, “there is no authority except that which is from God,” and “do not be afraid, for I am your God.” Leaders matter, and it is good to vote and pray, but safety rests in the Lord, who rules over all rulers.

> *“Put not your trust in princes, in mortal man, who cannot save”* (Psalm 146:3).

Also see

> “Some trust in chariots and others in horses, but we trust in the name of the LORD our God” (Psalm 20:7).

> “It is better to take refuge in the LORD than to trust in man” (Psalm 118:8).

> “The king’s heart is a waterway in the hand of the LORD; He directs it where He pleases” (Proverbs 21:1).

> “He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty. I will say to the LORD, ‘You are my refuge and my fortress, my God, in whom I trust.’” (Psalm 91:1–2).

Common self-statements

- If they win, we are doomed.
- Only the right leader can protect me.
- My safety depends on elections.
- I will not be okay until they are in charge.
- The other side will ruin everything.
- I must win.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either safe or in danger depending on who governs.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know what leaders will do.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling afraid and concluding that disaster is coming.
- Fortune telling: Predicting catastrophe.

Challenging questions

- What am I afraid of, specifically?
- Have I felt this fear before in other elections? What happened?
- What does Scripture say about trusting leaders?
- Where does my real security come from?

- What can I control?
- How can I pray and act without putting my trust in leaders?

Truth summary

> My safety and hope are in God, who rules over all rulers. I can vote, pray, and engage thoughtfully without placing the weight of my security on any leader or party.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Fear
- Trust
- Worldly
- Peace
- Anxiety/Worry

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If the right people were in power, I would finally be safe"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If the right people were in power, I would finally be safe." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I fear?
- ☐ What happened before?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ Where is my security?
- ☐ What can I control?
- ☐ How can I pray?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I will not trust in princes.
- ☐ The Lord is my refuge.
- ☐ God directs the hearts of kings.
- ☐ I trust in the name of the Lord.
- ☐ I can vote and pray.
- ☐ My security does not depend on elections.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 146:3
  "Put not your trust in princes, in mortal man, who cannot save."
- ☐ Psalm 20:7
  "Some trust in chariots and others in horses, but we trust in the name of the LORD our God."
- ☐ Psalm 91:1–2
  "He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty. I will say to the LORD, 'You are my refuge and my fortress, my God, in whom I trust.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Trust in the Lord: Each week, note one time you moved from fear of leaders to trust in God.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 146:3 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will not put my trust in princes. The Lord is my refuge.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Trust" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Name the fear. Write what you fear will happen.
- [ ] Look back. Write what happened after past elections.
- [ ] Pray for leaders. Pray for those you support and those you do not.
- [ ] Read Psalm 91. Rest in the shelter of the Most High.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If the right people were in power, I would finally be safe": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Trust in the Lord
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If the right people were in power, I would finally be safe.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have looked to leaders for safety. You are my refuge and fortress. Settle my heart, and help me vote, pray, and live without fear. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #55 · POLITICS AND GOVERNMENT

“I can't trust anyone in authority.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Abuse of power, broken promises, scandals, or a harsh parent or boss can teach that people in charge are dangerous or corrupt. We become suspicious, defensive, or rebellious, even toward good leaders.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is honest about corrupt rulers, and also about good ones. Peter and the apostles said, “We must obey God rather than men.” Paul writes, “Remind the believers to submit to rulers and authorities… to malign no one, and to be peaceable and gentle,” and Proverbs warns, “The simple man believes every word, but the prudent man watches his steps.” Jesus said, “be as shrewd as snakes and as innocent as doves.” The healthy path is discernment: not blind trust and not blanket distrust. Our deepest trust belongs to God, who is always trustworthy.

> *“Behold, I am sending you out like sheep among wolves; therefore be as shrewd as snakes and as innocent as doves”* (Matthew 10:16).

Also see

> “But Peter and the other apostles replied, ‘We must obey God rather than men.’” (Acts 5:29).

> “Remind the believers to submit to rulers and authorities, to be obedient and ready for every good work, to malign no one, and to be peaceable and gentle, showing full consideration to everyone” (Titus 3:1–2).

> “The simple man believes every word, but the prudent man watches his steps” (Proverbs 14:15).

> “Everyone must submit himself to the governing authorities, for there is no authority except that which is from God. The authorities that exist have been appointed by God” (Romans 13:1).

Common self-statements

- All leaders are corrupt.
- They will use me.
- I have to protect myself from them.
- Authority means danger.
- I trust no one in charge.
- They are all the same.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing authorities are either perfect or corrupt.
- Mind reading: Assuming bad intent.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling betrayed and concluding that all are untrustworthy.
- Fortune telling: Predicting harm.

Challenging questions

- Who hurt my trust in authority, and what happened?
- Have I met any authority who was trustworthy?

- What does discernment look like instead of blanket distrust?
- What does Scripture say about authority?
- Where is my deepest trust?
- How could I test trust in small steps?

Truth summary

> Some leaders failed me, but not all authorities are dangerous. I can grow in discernment, speak up when needed, and place my deepest trust in God, who is always faithful.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Wisdom
- Forgiveness
- Obedience
- Anger

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Death and Dying
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Truth Be Told — Matthew West featuring Carly Pearce
Honesty about struggles makes room for grace and support instead of pretending to be fine.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I can't trust anyone in authority"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I can't trust anyone in authority." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who hurt my trust?
- ☐ Who was trustworthy?
- ☐ What is discernment?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ Where is my trust?
- ☐ What small test?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I must obey God above men.
- ☐ I can be shrewd and innocent.
- ☐ The prudent watch their steps.
- ☐ Not all authorities are the same.
- ☐ I can give trust in small steps.
- ☐ God is always trustworthy.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Matthew 10:16
  "Behold, I am sending you out like sheep among wolves; therefore be as shrewd as snakes and as innocent as doves."
- ☐ Proverbs 14:15
  "The simple man believes every word, but the prudent man watches his steps."
- ☐ Acts 5:29
  "But Peter and the other apostles replied, 'We must obey God rather than men.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

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PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Discernment, not distrust: Each week, note one authority you assessed fairly.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Matthew 10:16 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can be shrewd and innocent, and trust God above all.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
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- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Name the hurt. Write who hurt your trust and what happened.
- [ ] List trustworthy ones. Write any authority who earned your respect.
- [ ] Test small. Trust someone with something small.
- [ ] Pray for wisdom. Ask for discernment.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I can't trust anyone in authority": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Discernment, not distrust
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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I can't trust anyone in authority.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I was hurt by those in charge. Heal my trust, give me discernment, and help me trust You above all, who never fail. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.